Wrestling skin checks for parents

Mat Rats and Valkyries families | Grindstone Wrestling Club

Use these examples to recognize a skin concern and know whom to contact. Photos cannot diagnose your child. Appearance varies with skin tone and stage; different conditions can look alike.

Example photo	Possible clues
 Ringworm example	**Ringworm** An itchy, scaly patch, often ring-shaped with a raised edge. It may look red, gray or brown. Scalp scaling or patches of hair loss also need evaluation.
 Impetigo example	**Impetigo** Sores or blisters that open, ooze and develop a yellow or honey-colored crust. Often seen around the nose or mouth, but can occur elsewhere.
 MRSA abscess example	**Staph infection including MRSA** A warm, swollen, painful bump or sore, sometimes with pus. It may resemble a pimple or spider bite. A photo cannot tell whether it is MRSA.

If you notice a suspicious spot

1. Talk to the coach before the next practice or meet. Explain what you noticed and ask about the team's process for a possible skin infection. The coach can explain participation requirements; a healthcare professional identifies the condition.

2. Have a healthcare professional check it. Tell them your child wrestles. Ask what the spot is, whether it is contagious, and whether a cream or another treatment is appropriate. Let that professional recommend the care.

3. Check what is needed before returning. Ask the coach which medical note or skin-release form, if any, the league or event requires. Follow the healthcare professional's guidance and the event's return process before your child wrestles again.

Sources: CDC ringworm | CDC impetigo | CDC athletes | USA Wrestling medical rules

Photos: CDC PHIL, available free at phil.cdc.gov. Use does not imply CDC/HHS/U.S. Government endorsement. Captions link to originals; full credits accompany this handout.